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Customer Retention in B2B SaaS

A study of 240 subscription businesses by the Acme Research Group

1. Introduction

Retention is the quiet driver of growth in subscription businesses. This report examines how 240 companies structure customer success, pricing and onboarding, and which of those choices correlate with net revenue retention above 110 percent. The data were collected between January and June 2026 through structured interviews and billing exports.

2. Methodology

We followed a three-stage process to ensure that the findings are comparable across companies of different sizes and maturity.

1. Select companies with at least twelve months of billing history.
2. Normalise revenue data to constant currency.
3. Interview the head of customer success at each company.

3. Key findings

- Companies with a named onboarding owner retained 9 points more revenue.
- Annual contracts reduced logo churn but hid dissatisfaction until renewal.
- Usage-based pricing correlated with faster expansion in mid-market accounts.

4. Conclusions

Retention is determined less by any single tactic than by whether a company treats the first ninety days as a product in its own right. We recommend that leaders measure time-to-value explicitly and assign a single accountable owner.

For more information, contact the research team at research@acme.org or visit www.acme.org/research.